Alvarado Score — Acute Appendicitis (MANTRELS)

adults with RIF pain · casualty

Alvarado 0–10

CRITERIA (MANTRELS)

Item	Points
Symptoms	
Migration of pain to the right iliac fossa	+1
Anorexia (or ketonuria)	+1
Nausea or vomiting	+1
Signs	
Tenderness in the right iliac fossa	+2
Rebound tenderness	+1
Elevated temperature ≥37.3 °C	+1
Laboratory	
Leucocytosis >10 × 10^9/L	+2
Shift to the left (neutrophils >75%)	+1
Total	**0–10**

PEARLS

- Supports, never replaces, clinical judgement and serial examination
- Women of child-bearing age: pregnancy test first — exclude ectopic
- Less reliable in children (use PAS), pregnancy, the elderly and HIV
- Mnemonic MANTRELS = Migration, Anorexia, Nausea, Tenderness, Rebound, Elevated T, Leucocytosis, Shift

INTERPRETATION

1–4 Appendicitis unlikely — consider other causes; re-examine

5–6 Compatible / equivocal — observe, repeat score, surgical opinion

7–8 Probable appendicitis — surgical referral

9–10 Very probable appendicitis — surgical referral

SA STG

Suspected appendicitis: nil by mouth; sodium chloride 0.9% IV ✚

Refer ALL patients with suspected appendicitis ✚

Treat associated pain while awaiting transfer ✚

PHC STG & EML Primary Healthcare, 8th ed. 2024 (updated Sept 2026) — pp 2.7, 2.8 · **ALVARADO** Alvarado A. Ann Emerg Med 1986;15:557-64